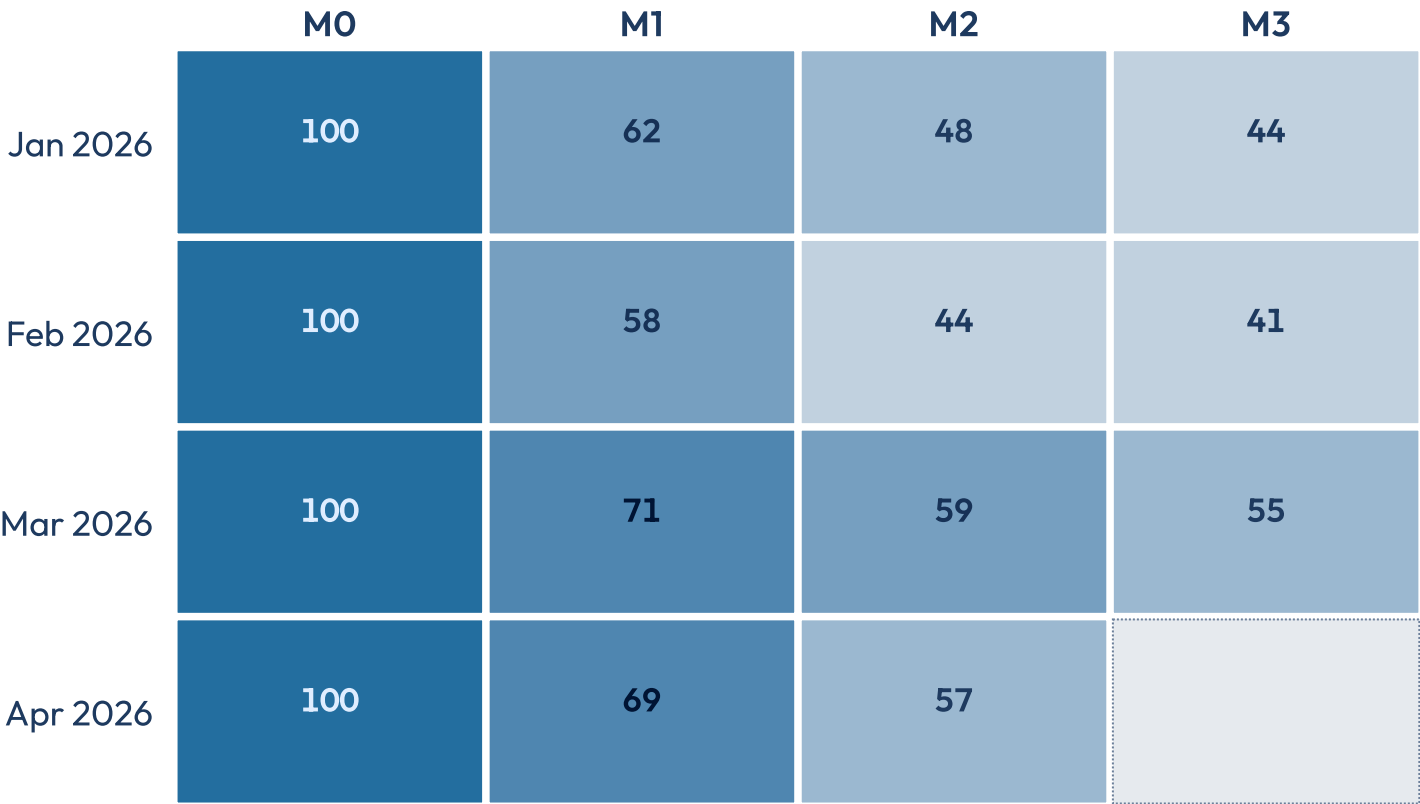


EVIDENCE • CANVAS • SERIES

# heatmap

A numeric matrix read as intensity — where the value concentrates across two dimensions.

# Retention decays fastest in month two.



RETENTION · THE CEILING

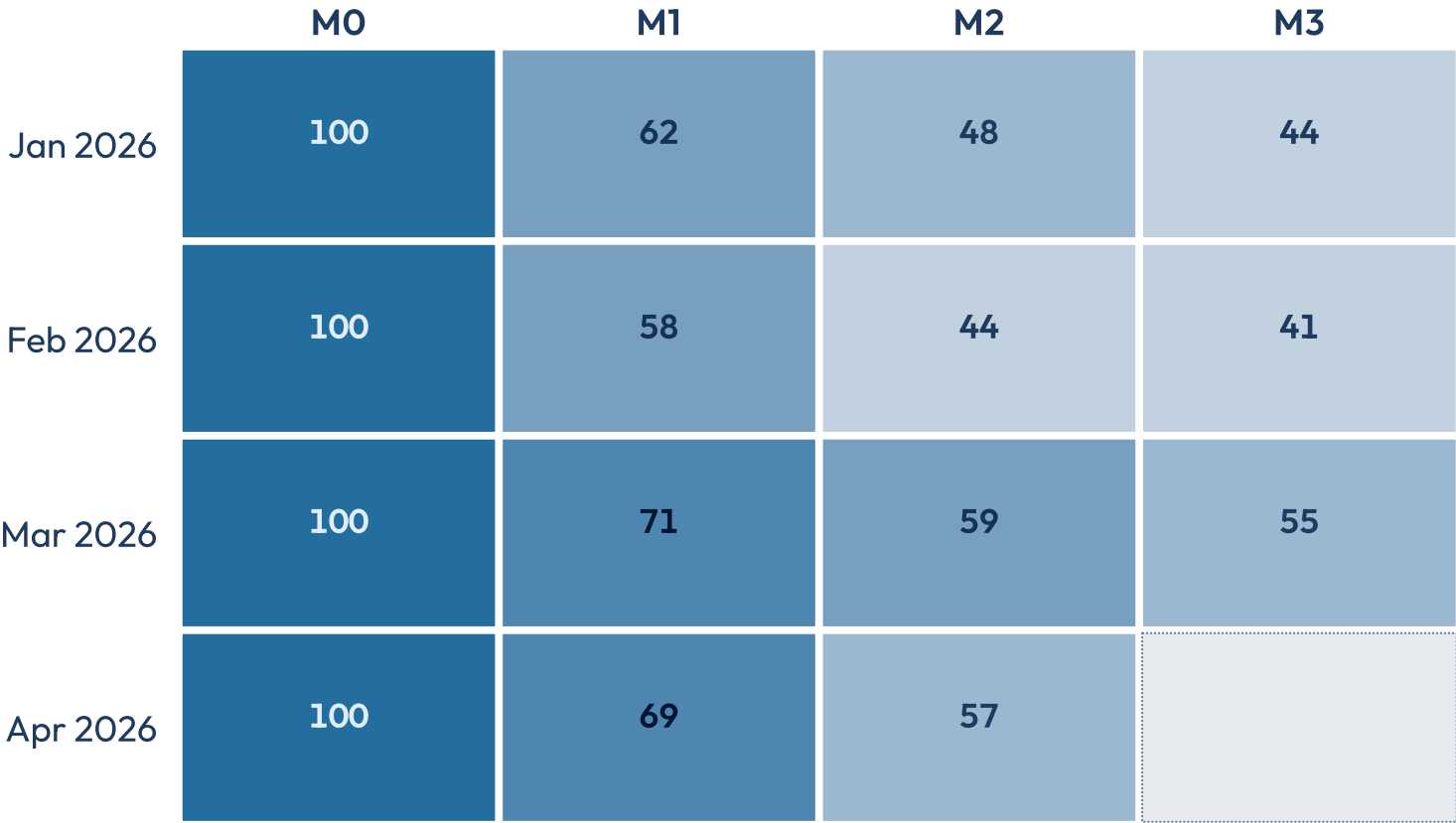
# Ten cohorts by twelve months — the density this holds.

|              | M0  | M1 | M2 | M3 | M4 | M5 | M6 | M7 | M8 | M9 | M10 | M11 |
|--------------|-----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-----|-----|
| January...   | 100 | 71 | 59 | 55 | 52 | 50 | 48 | 47 | 46 | 45 | 44  | 43  |
| February...  | 100 | 58 | 44 | 41 | 39 | 38 | 37 | 36 | 35 | 34 | 33  | 32  |
| March 2026   | 100 | 62 | 48 | 45 | 43 | 42 | 41 | 40 | 39 | 38 | 37  |     |
| April 2026   | 100 | 69 | 57 | 54 | 51 | 49 | 48 | 47 | 46 | 45 |     |     |
| May 2026     | 100 | 66 | 54 | 50 | 48 | 47 | 46 | 45 | 44 |    |     |     |
| June 2026    | 100 | 64 | 52 | 49 | 47 | 46 | 45 | 44 |    |    |     |     |
| July 2026    | 100 | 61 | 50 | 47 | 45 | 44 | 43 |    |    |    |     |     |
| August...    | 100 | 59 | 48 | 45 | 43 | 42 |    |    |    |    |     |     |
| September... | 100 | 57 | 47 | 44 | 42 |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |
| October...   | 55  | 55 | 55 | 55 |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |

# Retention decays fastest in month two.

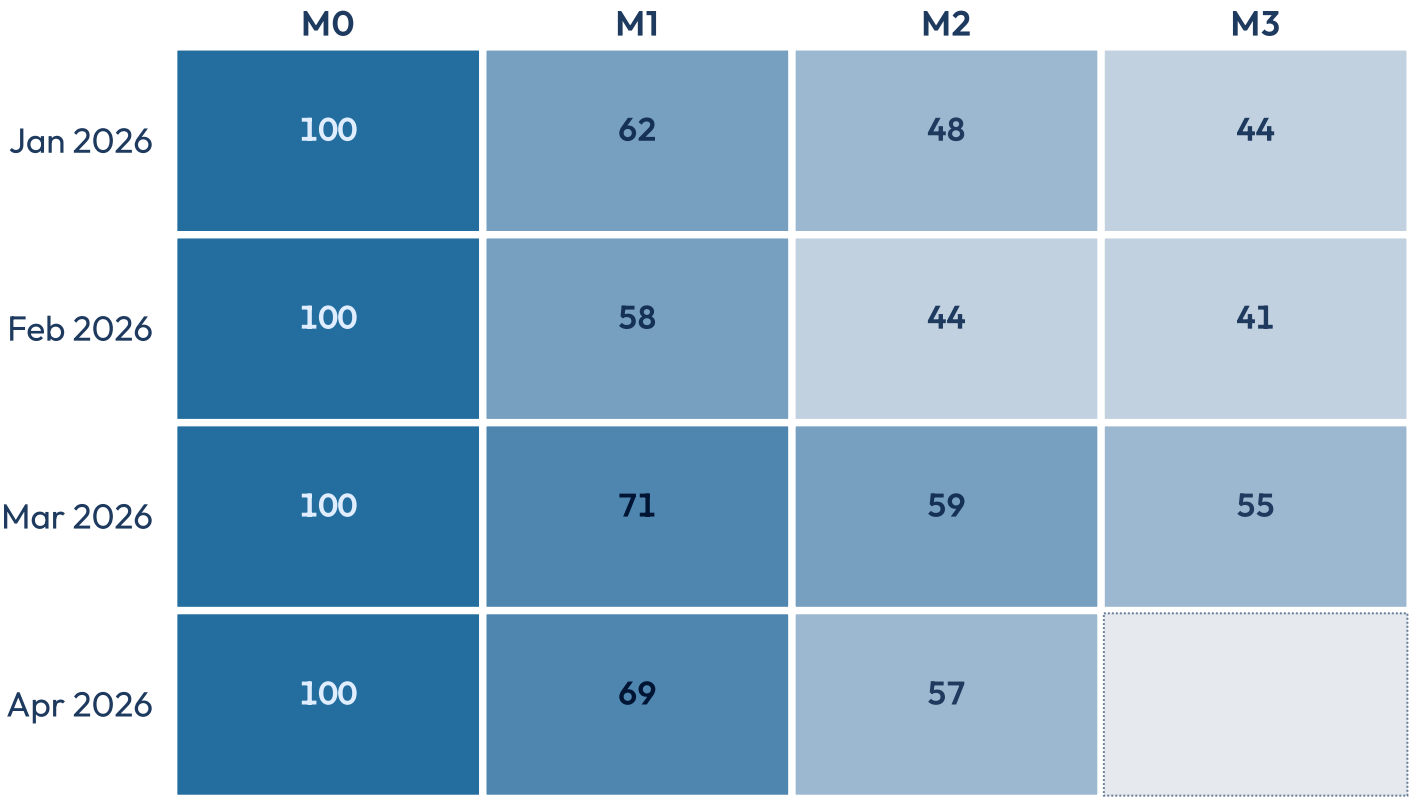
|          | M0  | M1 | M2 | M3 |
|----------|-----|----|----|----|
| Jan 2026 | 100 | 62 | 48 | 44 |
| Feb 2026 | 100 | 58 | 44 | 41 |
| Mar 2026 | 100 | 71 | 59 | 55 |
| Apr 2026 | 100 | 69 | 57 |    |

# Retention decays fastest in month two.



RETENTION • 2026 COHORTS

# Retention decays fastest in month two.



# When NOT to reach for heatmap.

## One row of numbers

A single series is not a matrix — it is a comparison, and a reader judges length far more precisely than intensity. Use `bar`. The kernel declines a one-column table for this reason rather than painting a single strip.

## Qualitative cells

If the cells are verbs, owners or statuses rather than numbers, the ramp has nothing to encode. Use `matrix-grid`, whose cells are tagged at parse time.

## Precise comparison

Asking a reader which of two similar cells is larger spends the one thing intensity is bad at, and the five-tone binning above makes it stricter: two cells in the same band are the same color by design. If the comparison has to be exact, the value belongs on an axis — `bar` or `line`.

## Geography

A value per country or region belongs on the `map` choropleth, which shares this ramp but places the cells where the reader expects them.

## RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`matrix-grid` — the cells are qualitative — a verb, an owner, a status — rather than a number

`map` — the two dimensions are geographic; same ramp, spatial placement

`bar` — one dimension, and the comparison has to be exact

`quadrant` — two CONTINUOUS axes with items placed on them, rather than two categorical axes with a value at each crossing